

Privileged Access Policy

Document No. POL-IAM-007	Effective Date 2026-08-10	Owner IT Security / IAM Team	Review Cycle Annual
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1. Purpose

This policy governs the use of administrative and service accounts within the Danotech environment to reduce the risk associated with elevated access.

2. Separation of Admin and Standard Accounts

Administrative access is never granted to a user's standard, day-to-day account. Personnel requiring elevated privileges are issued a separate, dedicated administrative account, held in OU=Admin Accounts, distinct from their standard account in OU=Employees.

- Standard account: used for email, file access, and general business applications.
- Admin account: used only when performing privileged administrative tasks (e.g. AD management, server administration).
- Admin accounts are named distinctly from the standard account (e.g. a-jsmith) to make privileged activity clearly identifiable in logs.

3. Service Accounts

Service accounts are used exclusively for automated processes and application-to-application authentication. Service accounts must not be used for, or capable of, interactive logon.

- The “Deny log on locally” and “Deny log on through Remote Desktop Services” rights are applied to all service accounts via Group Policy.
- Service accounts are not added to interactive login groups (e.g. SG-VPN-Access) unless explicitly required and approved.
- Service account passwords are long, randomly generated, and rotated on a defined schedule or upon suspected compromise.

4. Membership Control

Membership in privileged groups (e.g. SG-IT-Admins, Domain Admins) is reviewed quarterly per POL-IAM-002 and requires Resource Owner approval for any addition, per the approval chain in POL-IAM-001.

5. Monitoring

All authentication activity from admin and service accounts is logged and retained for audit purposes, with anomalous use (e.g. interactive logon attempts on a service account) alerted to IT Security.